

AL-MUNTAJAB ISSA



Expert Video Editor, Lighting & Sound Designer with 8+ Years of Experience

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Creative and detail-oriented Video Editor and Lighting & Sound Designer with over 8 years of extensive experience in video editing, lighting, sound design, and scenography. Proven track record of delivering high-impact promotional content, documentaries, and theatrical performances. Skilled in industry-standard software with a collaborative spirit and a passion for visual storytelling.

Experience

Lead Video Editor

Al Jazeera Media Network | Doha, Qatar / Remote | 2025 — Present

- Served as Lead Video Editor for Al Jazeera's prominent documentary show "The Rest of the Story", managing the full post-production workflow to deliver high-impact political and analytical investigative films.
- Edited major high-profile documentary episodes, including:
 - "Lebanon.. The Preemptive Strike"
 - "America and Iran.. Power Shifts"
 - "Syria.. Post-Sanctions"
- Utilized advanced narrative editing and rhythm-based techniques to weave complex archival footage, expert interviews, and political graphics into a cohesive, compelling, and brand-compliant visual story.
- Collaborated closely with directors and producers under tight journalistic deadlines to ensure absolute precision, technical excellence, and compliance with international broadcasting standards.

Video Production Specialist

Caritas (Austria & Switzerland) | Damascus, Syria | 2023 — Present

- Produced and edited compelling documentary and awareness videos highlighting humanitarian aid initiatives.
- Managed end-to-end post-production workflows to ensure alignment with international visual communication standards.

Media & Visual Projects Coordinator

Action Against Hunger & SSCC | Damascus, Syria | 2024 — 2025

- Managed and edited visual media initiatives and social awareness campaigns.
- Created high-quality video content to support field programmes and enhance stakeholder engagement.

Director & Commercial Video Editor

Shahba Aleppo Hotel | Aleppo / Damascus, Syria | 2023 — 2024

- Directed and edited premium promotional videos and targeted advertising campaigns.
- Developed tailored digital video campaigns designed to engage luxury hospitality clientele.

Lead Video Editor & Storytelling Collaborator

Rahalista Official YouTube Channel | Remote | 2023

- Collaborated closely with the creator on advanced narrative structure and visual storytelling, transforming raw travel footage into highly engaging, fast-paced documentary-style travel vlogs.
- Edited multiple high-profile, viral episodes that achieved exceptional audience retention and multi-million viewership milestones, including:
 - "Napoli.. The City of Chaos in Italy" (5.3 Million views)
 - "Gaddafi's Abandoned Hotel in Malta" (980K+ views)
 - "You Won't Believe How Much the People of Malta Resemble Arabs" (999K views)
 - "The Libyan Kashta (Zarda).. " (516K views)
 - "Seville as You've Never Seen It! Bullfighting & Alhambra Palace in Andalusia" (405K+ views)
- Utilized creative pacing, dynamic sound design, and contextual lower-thirds to enhance geographical exploration, resulting in a substantial boost in channel engagement and subscriber growth.

Promotional Video Editor

Dana Group (Pasta) & Media Jam Company | Damascus, Syria | 2020

- Edited high-impact promotional videos and marketing campaigns for Dana Pasta commercial products.
- Developed and edited interactive corporate and social media videos for diverse Media Jam clients.

YouTube Channel Manager & Lead Editor

Bassem Yakhour Official YouTube Channel | Damascus, Syria | 2019 — 2020

- Directed and edited exclusive visual content for one of the region's leading celebrity YouTube channels.
- Enhanced viewer retention and engagement metrics through the implementation of dynamic editing techniques.
- Significantly amplified channel performance and audience retention, curating content that broke previous viewership caps (~800K) to achieve a channel-record peak of 5.5 million views on a single video, alongside multiple viral videos reaching 2.6 million and over 1 million views.

Drama Teaser & Trailer Editor

Leading Drama Production Houses (Chicago Street, Bab Al-Hara 10) | Damascus, Syria | 2019 — 2020

- Edited official promotional teasers and trailers for highly acclaimed Syrian television series.
- Utilized visual effects and rhythm-based editing to maximize anticipation and engagement ahead of official releases.

Short Film Director & Video Editor

Uni-Pharma Corporate & Pharmaceutical Co. | Damascus, Syria | 2019

- Directed and edited a comprehensive corporate documentary showcasing laboratory departments.
- Conceptualised, directed, and edited creative stop-motion short films.

Theatrical Lighting & Sound Designer

National Theater & Ministry of Culture | Damascus, Syria | 2015 — 2019

- Designed and executed live lighting concepts for high-profile theatrical productions, including "Chalk Circle" (Dir. Ayman Zidan) and "Zujaj" (Dir. Oussama Ghanam).
- Managed full scenography and lighting layout for the "MWASSEM" Opening Concert.

Education

Higher Institute of Dramatic Arts - Damascus, 9/2014 — 9/2018

Bachelor's Degree in Visual Arts

Curriculum focused on stage, television, and cinema lighting, video editing, scenography, and sound engineering.

Diamond Future Academy for Training and Entrepreneurship, 4/2021 — 4/2023

Professional Diploma

Developed a strong entrepreneurial mindset and strategic vision for business growth
Cultivated advanced skills in organizational leadership and team management
Acquired a strategic, analytical approach to solving complex business challenges
Gained comprehensive expertise in core business operations and administration

Skills

• Technical & Soft Skills

- DaVinci Resolve (Advanced)
- Adobe Premiere Pro (Intermediate)
- Adobe After Effects & DaVinci Fusion (Advanced)
- Grass Valley EDIUS (Advanced)
- Adobe Photoshop (Advanced)
- Audio Engineering & Theatrical Lighting Design
- Creative Visual Storytelling & Narrative Structure
- Cross-Functional Collaboration & Director Alignment
- Time Management & Efficient Delivery Under Tight Production Deadlines

Languages

• Languages & Communication

- Arabic:** Native proficiency
- English:** Professional working proficiency

Hobbies

- **Fitness & Sports**
- **Music**
 - Music Video Editing
- **Professional Photography & Cinematography**